

MICHAEL KEUHLEN

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Professional Summary

Early-career cybersecurity professional with over a decade of high-stakes public service experience in emergency response, including 911 dispatch, law enforcement, corrections, and emergency pre-hospital care. Recent BAS graduate in Cybersecurity with hands-on academic experience in pfSense, Suricata, Qualys VMDR, and other security tools. Passionate about applying my public safety background and technical skills in a service-oriented cybersecurity role where I can continue protecting communities while growing in the field.

RELEVANT PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Field Systems Technician (Tier 2 IT Support) | 08/2022 – 05/2025

H&R Block – Multi-State Region

- Supported 23 offices across 2 states as the primary on-site IT resource, troubleshooting hardware, software, and network incidents to maintain business continuity across a multi-state region.
- Deployed and maintained 23 local servers (Windows Server 2016), 23 dedicated backup systems, and ~200 multi-role Windows 10 and 11 workstations (POS, production, and third-party software systems), and 100+ various other networked peripherals like printers, point of sale card readers, etc.
- Coordinated with senior IT and vendor teams to escalate and resolve critical business impact issues requiring a coordinated response.
- Served as a member of the dispatch authorization team confirming documentation and troubleshooting accuracy; Performed the final review on escalated tickets before any field dispatch was approved, holding decisions to a 30-minute SLA from case creation for mission-critical tickets.
- Resolved ~20 tickets per day remotely that had field dispatch or tier 3 escalation requests, significantly reducing unnecessary field time across the company.

ADDITIONAL PROJECTS & EXPERIENCE

BCES Cybersecurity Awareness Training – Capstone Project | 04/2025–06/2026

Partnering with Benton County Emergency Services (BCES) to design and deliver cybersecurity awareness training specifically tailored to public safety answering point (PSAP) staff. Training addresses social engineering, phishing, and insider threats most likely to target 911 communications environments. Developed training content aligned to NIST and NENA best practices and adapted to real 911 PSAP operational workflows. Delivered training to 29 organizational staff in 4 classes over 2 days. Documented improvement after training of ~50% reduction in errors from line staff in training scenarios.

Academic Security Work – Columbia Basin College | 2022–2026

Completed lab assignments in vulnerability scanning, event log analysis, and secure endpoint configuration using industry-standard tools and methodologies. Developed incident response plans, risk assessments, and security policies mapped to NIST, PCI DSS, and CIS Controls. Coursework included dedicated studies of cryptology, ethical hacking, penetration testing, wireless security, E-commerce security, Unix/Linux administration, and more.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Applied Science in Cybersecurity, *cum laude*
Columbia Basin College, 2026

CERTIFICATIONS

Qualys Vulnerability Management, Detection, and Response (VMDR) Specialist • 2026
CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) • 2026
CompTIA A+ (1101/1102) • 2024
FEMA/NIMS: ICS-100, ICS-200, IS-700, IS-800 • (2014 – 2020)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Vulnerability & Threat Management: Qualys VMDR, Suricata IDS, pfBlockerNG, Burp Suite
Security Frameworks & Compliance: NIST SP 800 series, PCI DSS standards, GRC policy drafting
Network Security: pfSense firewall configuration
Security Tools & Analysis: Wireshark, Nmap, inSSIDer, Packet and log analysis
Systems & Infrastructure: Windows 10/11 and Server 2016, Docker, Linux (CentOS), VMware, VirtualBox, Azure AD / Entra ID
Programming & Scripting: Python, SQL, and C++ academic foundational experience, Bash and PowerShell

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE – PUBLIC SAFETY & EMERGENCY RESPONSE

Emergency Communications Specialist - Aurora 911 | 10/2020 – 03/2022
Patrol Officer - Aurora Police Department | 02/2020 – 10/2020
Corrections and Custody Officer - Washington State DOC | 12/2013 – 02/2020
Emergency Medical Technician - Deer Park Ambulance | 04/2011 – 04/2013

AWARDS

Life Saving Award - City of Aurora | 2021
Eagle Scout - Boy Scouts of America | 2010